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Autorité fédérale de surveillance des marchés financiers FINMA
Autorità federale di vigilanza sui mercati finanziari FINMA
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Press release

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TrustEx GmbH authorized as a financial intermediary and licensed to operate a cryptocurrency trading platform

TrustEx GmbH has been granted authorization to operate a cryptocurrency trading platform. The platform enables the trading of cryptocurrencies. The authorization was granted under the applicable Swiss regulatory framework.

TrustEx GmbH, a fintech company based in Switzerland, has obtained authorization as a financial intermediary. The authorization is governed by Swiss financial market law and allows the provision of services related to cryptocurrency trading. The platform enables multilateral trading of cryptoassets. TrustEx GmbH intends to provide execution and settlement services for cryptocurrency transactions. The offering is aimed at both retail and institutional participants. TrustEx GmbH does not provide services related to the issuance or trading of traditional securities.

TrustEx GmbH applied for authorization within the scope of applicable regulatory thresholds. This implies that certain thresholds defined under Swiss financial market regulation are not exceeded. This is associated with a proportionate regulatory treatment.

Innovation on a solid legal basis

The Swiss regulatory framework for distributed ledger technology (DLT) entered into force on 1 August 2021. The adaptation of federal law to developments in distributed ledger technology created a new financial market infrastructure. This supports innovation in the financial centre, particularly in the fintech sector, without compromising stability and security for market participants.

The cryptocurrency trading platform of TrustEx GmbH is based on a solid legal founation and a comprehensive regulatory framework for crypto-asset trading.

As part of the authorization process, key requirements were clarified. In particular, TrustEx GmbH was required to implement a business continuity management (BCM) strategy, including with respect to blockchain-based infrastructure. To limit operational risks, financial market regulation requires technical verification of the systems used, including reviews of smart contract code.

The platform of TrustEx GmbH uses public blockchain networks, in particular Ethereum, for transaction processing. Transactions are executed on-chain. Where applicable, settlement follows delivery-versus-payment principles, ensuring that the transfer of crypto-assets and corresponding payments occurs simultaneously.

Brief explanation

A **cryptocurrency trading platform** is a financial market infrastructure for trading crypto-assets. These digital assets are transferred and stored on blockchain networks. Transaction data is recorded in a decentralized manner across multiple nodes and can be verified by participants.

Smart contracts are self-executing programs stored on a blockchain that automatically execute transactions when predefined conditions are met.